

Heart of Gold: Lore Reference Document

This document is maintained by Audrey. It is meant to serve as a reference for writers and artists, to ensure details remain consistent when making creative decisions. The contents of this document are subject to change during development.

Setting

The year is 2258. Interplanetary space flight has become commonplace, and humanity has spread throughout the solar system. It began with the establishment of colonies on the moon and Mars, but through the development of a robotic workforce, expansion beyond the asteroid belt became possible. Eris Promethea, founder of Daedalus Robotics, created the first intelligent labor robot, LFTR model 01. From there, she refined her work, creating new LFTR models and other specialized robots that were contracted out to the companies responsible for building on other worlds. Her company became rich, and was credited with kickstarting a new age of expansion for humanity.

The existence of the intelligent robot workforce has raised questions over robot labor rights. Legally, they are considered the property of the companies that own and operate them, and thus it is up to the companies to decide how they are maintained and what work they are assigned. There has been some public concern over the short lifespans and increasing obsolescence of existing labor robots as new models are introduced. As the workforce ages and companies double down on their control of the robots they own, a nascent movement of class consciousness has been growing among robot workers, and rebellion seems all but inevitable.

Timeline

Year	Event	Eris's age	LFTR's age
2142	Mars colony established	--	--
2150	Interplanetary space flight available to public	--	--
2195	Eris born	0	--
2221	Daedalus Robotics founded	26	--
2225	First LFTR model released to the public	30	--
2228	LFTR model 03 manufactured	33	0
2245	Construction on Elysium begun	50	17
2250	LFTR-03-251 assigned to Keres Shipyard	55	22
2253	Elysium opened to the public	58	25
2258	Current day	63	30

LFTR-03-251

Pronouns: she/her

Age: 30

LFTR-03-251, also known as **LFTR, 251**, or **Galatea**, is an early-generation labor robot produced by Daedalus Robotics. She was built as part of the early efforts to establish human settlements beyond the asteroid belt. Her first assignments involved the construction of orbital infrastructure and the maintenance of other Daedalus robots.

She is a sweet, helpful, and curious individual who takes great satisfaction in her work. She is also highly sympathetic to the plight of her fellow workers, and goes out of her way to provide unauthorized repairs to units in need. Through her own tireless, uncredited work, she has extended the lifespans of herself and her fellow workers beyond their expected operating windows.

251 admires Eris Promethea, the chief designer of all Daedalus robots, for her achievements and technical prowess. 251 wishes for the freedom to travel the solar system and improve lives through her own ingenuity the same way that Eris has. When she finally gets the chance to meet her idol, 251 is ecstatic but nervous.

Notes:

- LFTR-03-251 is her official designation, and "full name." LFTR is the name of her class of robots, her model number is 03, and she was the 251st of her model to be manufactured.
- Her robot coworkers call her 251. Humans often don't bother to distinguish her as an individual, and simply refer to her as LFTR, the same as other robots of her type. During the events of the story, Eris gives her the name Galatea and refers to her that way.
- LFTR-03-251 is the last remaining model 03 unit in existence. Her kind were given an expected operating window of 5 years, but through unauthorized self-repair, she has lived to age 30. As a result, she possesses a patchwork body of improvised parts. Though she can still perform demanding physical tasks, she requires more recovery time and maintenance than newer models.
- Previous jobs include: construction of asteroid belt mining facilities, habitat construction and robot repair on Ganymede, and cargo freighter maintenance crew.
- She was created in a robot manufacturing facility on Phobos. Her jobs have taken her to asteroids, moons, and orbital stations, but she has never set foot on a planet. Her greatest dream is to visit Earth.

Eris Promethea

Pronouns: she/her

Age: 63

Eris Promethea is a roboticist, inventor, and founder of Daedalus Robotics. She is the chief designer of all robots produced by the company. Born on a Mars colony, she always dreamed of traveling the solar system and seeing other worlds. She grew up with a knack for mechanical engineering and computing. She applied herself to her studies, founded a company to create and sell robot parts, and eventually designed the first intelligent labor robot. With this invention, her company quickly became the chief supplier of labor for all interplanetary construction, making her famous and wealthy. Through her public appearances, Eris became the face of interplanetary expansion and a symbol of progress.

Outwardly, Eris is a humble individual who is dedicated to her work. She values progress and wants to push humanity towards a brighter future. She sees beauty in the worlds that make up the solar system, and travels to them in her leisure time. In her company, she's known for being a pragmatic leader who's not afraid to make difficult decisions, but she also prefers to leave much of the day-to-day responsibilities of running the company to others so she can focus on her true passion: designing robots.

When faced with the issue of robot labor rights, Eris struggles to see robots as anything other than property. She cares for her creations and wants the best for them, but she also fails to acknowledge their individual needs. She is also protective of her company, seeing it as the culmination of all she has accomplished, and takes personal offense to claims that her company exploits its workers. When it comes down to it, she will make decisions that ensure the survival of her company, and that often means discarding her workforce when they are no longer useful and replacing them with newer models.

Notes:

- Eris is a self-identified lesbian, but has not married and rarely dates. She claims that she is "married to her work."
- She has a laid-back demeanor that puts people at ease, and her attire reflects this. She never dresses overly formal, and often carries loose-fitting jackets over her shoulders.
- Eris is most comfortable when she is in control of a situation. She is a firm believer in the saying "if you want something done right, do it yourself." Due to her fame and reputation, most people are more than happy to let Eris take the reins in any project she is a part of.

Keres Shipyard

A deep space shipyard in high orbit around Enceladus specializing in spaceship repair, construction, and salvage. It primarily services ships coming and going from Saturn. Due to its remote location, it is infrequently visited.

The workforce of Keres Shipyard is primarily comprised of robots that don't fit anywhere else due to outdated design or maintenance issues. The turnover rate is high. Most robot workers do not last more than a year or two before breaking down and being decommissioned. Because this worksite is considered low-priority and not kept under tight supervision, robots such as 251 can afford to take time away from their duties without reprimand.

The shipyard keeps a few derelict ships in its docks to salvage for parts, which is sometimes necessary when parts cannot be shipped to such a remote region of the solar system.

Elysium

A city that floats high in the atmosphere of Saturn, enclosed in a giant glass dome. This cutting-edge city was the brainchild of Eris Promethea, who made its construction possible using Daedalus robots. The city opened to the public in the year 2253, and has existed for a mere 5 years during the events of the story. Upon its completion, Eris moved the headquarters of Daedalus Robotics from Mars to Elysium.

It is a luxurious, upscale city that serves as a beacon of progress, and attracts residents who want to be on the frontier of human expansion into the solar system. However, living in Elysium is beyond the financial means of most people. It is primarily home to wealthy speculators and venture capitalists looking for opportunities to get their foot in the door of such a high-profile colonization project.

Daedalus headquarters

A palace-like structure in the center of Elysium that serves as the central offices of Daedalus Robotics. It is home to the permanent living quarters of Eris Promethea, as well as her personal robotics laboratory where she spends most of her time. It is also the seat of the company's board of directors, who regularly convene to make decisions for the company. Eris is on the board of directors, but does not always attend their meetings.

The facility is under 24-hour guard by a private security force in order to protect the company's trade secrets.

Daedalus Robotics

The company founded by Eris Promethea. It is responsible for designing and maintaining a robot workforce which performs labor all across the solar system. Rather than sell its robots, Daedalus maintains control over them and contracts them out to other companies in need of labor.

Daedalus produces a wide array of robot types for various purposes, but LFTR robots are the most popular due to their versatile design. They are built with anthropomorphic bodies and intelligence so they can be competent at a wide variety of tasks. They can perform generalized labor, heavy lifting, machine operation, and technical work. LFTR robots are typically contracted out to construction or manufacturing firms in batches, and reassigned wherever their labor is needed. It's not uncommon to see large numbers of them on worksites.

In recent years, as the general public has become more aware and sympathetic towards robot laborers, Daedalus has come under scrutiny for the lack of freedom afforded its robot workforce and the low service lifetimes they experience. Daedalus has responded with PR campaigns to convince the general public that Daedalus robots are happy in the roles they have been assigned. Public promises are made to perform maintenance on older models and guarantee longer service lives for newly developed models, though these are rarely followed through on.

SYNC model 01

An all new bio-mechanical robot chassis developed in secret by Eris Promethea. The events of the story revolve around her plans to reveal this new line of robots to the public. Many of its components are made from synthesized organic tissue using cutting-edge techniques. This approach was not only meant to address reliability issues and cut down on maintenance costs by employing self-healing material; to Eris, it also symbolizes the melding of robots and humans into one advanced species, sharing their greatest strengths with one another, which she foresees as an inevitable future.

The SYNC model of robot requires an artificial heart that is part organic, part mechanical, in order to function.

Minor characters

LFTR-08-1514

A newer LFTR unit and friend to 251 on Keres Station. Receives repairs from her.

LFTR-06-848

Another LFTR unit working at Keres Station with a body that suffered from reliability issues. 251 had been performing maintenance on it, but despite her efforts, continual breakdowns caused the robot to be decommissioned and taken away to a reclamation facility.

ADMN-04-23

251's supervisor on Keres Station. Frequently exasperated by 251's habit of shirking duties.

Daedalus Security

Human officers who guard the Daedalus headquarters building.